

KAHAD ADAMU, PhD

Akron, OH. 20910

(716) 520 - 8127

kahadadamu1991@gmail.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D. (2025), The State University of New York (SUNY) at Buffalo, Urban and Regional Planning

Dissertation: Institutional Externalities in the Governance of Cuyahoga River Watershed (CRW): Essays on Environmental Governance

Dissertation Committee: Dr. Emmanuel Frimpong Boamah, Dr. Samina Raja, Dr. Susan Clark, Dr. Lucie Laurien

MSc. (2016), University College London, Urban Development Planning

Dissertation: State and Traditional Land Institutions' Coordination for Improved Land Governance in Ghana: The Role of the Customary Land Secretariat (CLS)

Advisor: Prof. Colin Marx

BSc. (Honors) (2014), Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST), Land Economy

Thesis: The Growth and Challenges of Mortgage Origination in Ghana

Advisor: Dr. Frank Gyamfi-Yeboah

POSITIONS

- North-East Ohio Workforce in Nursing (NEOWIN) Impact Grant Data Specialist, Stark State College (February 2026 – Present)
- Research Assistant, Just Institutions Lab, SUNY- University at Buffalo (May 2025 – Present)
- Social Scientist/Economics/Database Manager, National Sea Grant College Program, National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) (February 2025–Feb 2026)
- Co-Instructor & Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Urban and Regional Planning, SUNY – University at Buffalo (August 2021–May 2025)
- Research Assistant & Administrator, Community for Global Health Equity, SUNY-University at Buffalo (May 2023–August 2024)
- Research Aide & GIS Analyst, Food Systems Planning and Healthy Community Lab, SUNY-University at Buffalo (May 2022–May 2023)
- Adjunct Lecturer, Department of Estate Management, Kumasi Technical University, Kumasi, Ghana (September 2018–July 2019)

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Adamu, K.** (2026). Institutional Externalities and Collaborative Governance in the Cuyahoga River Watershed (CRW). *Environmental Policy and Governance*, 36(2), 280-296.
2. Judelsohn, A., Frimpong Boamah, E., **Adamu, K.**, Yin, F., Paltseva, A., Kordas, K., Parasnis, M., Chen, T., & Nalam, P. (2025). Envisioning Healthy Soil Futures: Planning

- and Policy Inertia in Addressing Soil Contamination in a Postindustrial City. *Journal of Planning Education and Research*, 0(0). <https://doi.org/10.1177/0739456X251373027>
3. Boamah, E. F., Yeboah, T., **Adamu, K.**, Yin, F., Yeleliere, E., Appai, T. P., & Twum, K. O. (2025). State-mandated decentralized irrigation reforms:(re) thinking Africa's irrigation commons using the state-reinforced self-governance framework. *Ecology and Society*, 30(2).
 4. **Adamu, K.**, Boamah, E. F., & Siaw-Asamoah, D. (2025). Infrastructural violence and urban development in African cities: The case of Takoradi Central Market in Ghana. *Habitat International*, 155, 103232.
 5. **Adamu, K.**, Frimpong Boamah, E., & Grooms, W. (2023). Global South growth machines? A political-economic view of urban redevelopment and dispossessions in sub-Saharan Africa. *Journal of Urban Affairs*, 46(10), 2240–2258. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07352166.2022.2155526>
 6. Frimpong Boamah, E., Watson, V., Amoako, C., Grooms, W., Osei, D., Osei Kwadwo, V., Nyamekye, A.B., **Adamu, K.**, Appiah, G.K. (2021). Planning Corruption or Corrupting Planning? A Sub-Saharan Africa Perspective. *Journal of the American Planning Association*, 88(3), 377–391. <https://doi.org/10.1080/01944363.2021.1987969>

WORKS UNDER REVIEW

1. 'From Awareness to Action: Trust, Capacity, and Responses to Urban Soil Health Risks within the Karen Immigrant and Refugee Community in Buffalo, New York' with Frimpong Boamah E., Judelsohn A., Visca L., Kordas, K. (Cities & Health)
2. 'Discourse Legitimization in contested and competing Regulatory Policies for the Ohio River. (Journal of Environmental Planning and Management)
3. 'Dams, Lakes, and Regimes of Eco-Exploitation in Africa: A Case of the Volta Lake' with Yeleliere E. & Frimpong Boamah, E. (Forthcoming, Book Chapter).
4. 'Health (in)equities around urban soil contaminants: A mediation analysis of factors reinforcing commitments to healthy soil futures in Buffalo, NY' with Frimpong Boamah, E., Judelsohn, A., Kordas, K., Paltseva, A., Prathima, N., & Wodo, O. (Urban Studies Journal)

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

1. "Institutional and Policy Logics that underpin the proliferation of gated communities," with Yeleliere, E., and Frimpong Boamah, E.
2. Collective Action in Governing the Cuyahoga River: The Role of Institutional Externalities, Social Capital, and Resource Capacities of Actors
3. Ghana's New Land Act 2020 (Act 1036): A bane or boon to land problems. Using Institutional Grammar (IG) to examine institutional weaknesses and inconsistencies.
4. A Systematic Review of the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) in Infrastructural Provision in Sub-Saharan Africa.

CONFERENCE ATTENDED

1. Presenter, Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP), Seattle, Washington, U.S. (November 7 – 9, 2024) – *Paper title*: Resource and Power in Forum Participation in Governance of Water Commons.
2. Contributor, Workshop of the Ostrom Workshop (WOW) 7 Conference, Bloomington, Indiana. State-Reinforced Self-Governance Team, Member. (June 19 – 21, 2024)

3. Presenter, International Conference on Urban Affairs (UAA), New York City, U.S. (April 24 – 27, 2024) *Paper title: Competing Spatial Rationalities and Structural Violence in Ghana's Peri-Urban Regions*
4. Presenter, International Conference on Public Policy, Toronto, Canada, (June 27 – 19, 2023) *Paper title: Retail or Marketplace Redevelopment Not for Everyone: Uncovering Infrastructure Violence in Sub-Saharan Africa (presenter)*
5. Presenter, International Conference on Urban Affairs (UAA), Washington, DC. (April 12 – 14, 2022) *Paper title: Infrastructural Violence and Marketplace Redevelopment in Ghana.*

COURSES TAUGHT (^ as Teaching Assistant & * as Co-Instructor)

<i>Courses</i>	<i>Level</i>	<i>Semester</i>
Research Methods for Planning*	Graduate	Fall 2021
Urban and Environmental Planning^	Undergraduate	Spring 2022
Visions of the City*	Undergraduate	Spring 2022
Research Methods for Planning*	Graduate	Fall 2022
Environmental Design Studio^	Undergraduate	Fall 2022
Visions of the City*	Undergraduate	Spring 2023
Environmental Design Studio^	Undergraduate	Spring 2023
Environmental Design Studio^	Undergraduate	Fall 2023
Urban and Environmental Planning ^	Undergraduate	Spring 2024
Landscape and Planning^	Undergraduate	Spring 2024
Environmental Design Studio^	Undergraduate	Fall 2024
Urban and Regional Planning^	Undergraduate	Spring 2025

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

- Knauss Sea Grant Fellowship (2025)
- School of Architecture and Planning, SUNY – University at Buffalo, Doctoral Scholarship (2021-2025)
- Presidential Fellowship, University at Buffalo (2021–2025)
- Commonwealth Shared Scholarship, University College London (2015)

OTHER CERTIFICATES

1. Generative AI for Practitioners – Great Learning (May 2026)
2. Applied Data Science – Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (Dec 2025)
3. Mastering Big Data Analytics – Great Learning (Nov 2025)
4. Introduction to Artificial Intelligence on Cloud – Great Learning & MIT Professional Education (Jul 2025)
5. Spatial Data Science: The New Frontier in Analytics – ESRI (Nov 2022)
6. Imagery in Action – ESRI (Oct 2023)
7. GIS for Climate Action – ESRI (Nov 2023)
8. Going Places with Spatial Analysis – ESRI (Feb 2024)
9. Cartography – ESRI (May 2024)
10. Make an Impact with Modern Geo Apps – ESRI (Oct 2024)